NESS Heritage

Auschwitz-Birkenau AR Memorial

User Guide

A comprehensive guide to every feature of the
NESS Heritage augmented reality memorial application.

140 points of interest | 11 languages | Offline support

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This guide accompanies the NESS Heritage mobile application.

User Guide

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1. Introduction

Welcome to NESS Heritage, an augmented reality memorial experience that guides you through the Auschwitz-Birkenau State Museum. This application uses your smartphone camera, GPS, and AI to provide an immersive, educational, and deeply respectful journey through one of the most significant Holocaust memorial sites in the world.

About This Guide

This guide walks you through every feature of the NESS Heritage application in detail. Whether you are a first-time visitor planning your trip or a returning user exploring advanced features, you will find clear instructions, tips, and context for each capability the app offers.

About Auschwitz-Birkenau

Auschwitz was the largest of the Nazi German concentration and extermination camps. Established in 1940 in occupied Poland, it consisted of three main camps: Auschwitz I (the main camp), Auschwitz II-Birkenau (the extermination camp), and Auschwitz III-Monowitz (a labor camp). Over 1.1 million people — predominantly Jews, but also Poles, Roma, Soviet prisoners of war, and others — were murdered here between 1940 and 1945. Today, the site is a UNESCO World Heritage Site and a museum dedicated to remembrance and education.

App Philosophy

NESS Heritage was created to deepen the visitor experience through technology — not to replace the solemnity of the physical site, but to provide context, history, and personal reflection tools. Every feature is designed with respect for the victims and the sacred nature of this place.

Key Features at a Glance

- 140 scannable points of interest across Auschwitz I and Birkenau.
- Augmented reality navigation with a pink fluorescent guided path.
- AI-powered scan that identifies and explains structures through your camera.
- Interactive site map with real-time GPS tracking and visited-site progress.
- Route planning with automatic walking-path optimization from your chosen start.
- Audio guide narration generated on demand for each point of interest.
- Photo capture and social sharing directly from the AR camera view.
- Personal journal for reflections tied to visited sites.
- Three AI assistants: a Navigator for directions, a Historian for context, and a Storyteller for survivor stories.
- Paid access to the Storyteller and Historian agents via MetaMask (Ethereum), from 30 minutes up to 10 hours.
- Multi-language support in 11 of the most spoken languages worldwide.
- Proximity alerts that gently notify you as you approach each site.

- Full offline mode for areas with poor cellular coverage.

2. Getting Started

This section covers everything you need before your first AR-guided tour.

Device Requirements

- A smartphone with a rear-facing camera (iOS or Android).
- GPS / location services capability.
- Sufficient battery charge — AR and GPS are power-intensive; a portable charger is recommended.
- Headphones are strongly recommended for the audio guide, to maintain a quiet atmosphere at the memorial.
- An internet connection for the first launch (to download site data). Offline mode can be enabled afterward.

Creating an Account

NESS Heritage requires a free account to save your journal entries, route plans, and visit progress. You can register with an email address and password, or sign in with Google.

1. Open the app. If you are not logged in, you will be redirected to the login screen.
2. Tap "Create account" to register with email, or tap the Google button to sign in with your Google account.
3. If registering with email, enter your email and a password, then confirm the password.
4. A verification code (OTP) will be sent to your email. Enter the code to verify your account.
5. Once verified, you will be logged in and taken to the home screen.

Permissions

On first launch, the app will request the following permissions. Granting all of them ensures the full experience:

- Camera: Required for AR Navigation, Scan & Learn, and photo capture.
- Location (GPS): Required for navigation, proximity alerts, map tracking, and offline scanning.
- Notifications: Optional, but recommended for proximity alerts.
- Storage: Used to save captured photos to your device.

First Launch Checklist

1. Charge your phone to at least 50%.
2. Grant camera and location permissions when prompted.
3. Connect headphones.
4. Select your preferred language from the globe icon in the top-right corner.
5. Download offline data (recommended) from the Offline Center before you arrive.
6. Plan a route based on your available time from the Plan Your Route screen.

3. Home Screen Overview

The home screen is your central hub. From here, you can access every feature of the app.

Header

The header displays the NESS Heritage logo with a pink fluorescent accent. Two primary action buttons are available: "Start AR Tour" (launches AR Navigation) and "Scan Site" (launches the Scan feature).

Feature Cards

Below the header, a series of feature cards provide quick access to each capability:

- AR Navigation — Launch the augmented reality guided path.
- Scan & Learn — Identify a structure through your camera with AI.
- Site Map — View all 110 points on an interactive map with live tracking.
- Plan Your Route — Customize your visit by duration, interests, and starting location.
- AI Assistant — Chat with the Navigator or Historian agent.
- User Guide — Download this guide as a PDF.
- Offline Mode — Download or manage offline data.

Featured Points

The bottom of the home screen shows the first few points of interest from the recommended route. Tap any card to view full details, or tap "View All" to open the Site Map.

Bottom Navigation

A persistent bottom navigation bar appears on every screen with five tabs: Home, Navigate, Scan, Map, and Journal. Use these to move between the core features without returning to the home screen.

4. AR Navigation

The AR Navigation feature overlays a pink fluorescent guide line on your camera view, leading you from one point of interest to the next. As you walk, waypoint cards appear showing the name and description of each upcoming site.

Launching AR Navigation

Tap "Navigate" in the bottom menu or "Start AR Tour" on the home screen. The app will activate your rear camera and display the AR overlay.

On-Screen Elements

- Progress indicator (top): Shows your current waypoint number and total (e.g., "3 / 12").
- Pink fluorescent path: A glowing animated line that traces the route to your next waypoint.
- Waypoint markers: Numbered circles along the path indicating each point of interest.
- Current waypoint card (bottom): Shows the name, short description, and action buttons for the active site.
- Camera capture button (right side): A circular button to take a photo.

How to Navigate

1. Hold your phone vertically in front of you as you walk.
2. Follow the pink path on screen toward the next waypoint.
3. When you reach a site, its waypoint card appears at the bottom.
4. Tap "Details" on the card to open the full point-of-interest page with audio guide, description, and reflection options.
5. Tap "Next" to advance to the following waypoint on your route.
6. The app tracks your progress automatically as you reach each waypoint.

Planned Route Integration

If you created a route in the Plan Your Route screen, the AR Navigator will follow your optimized walking order. A "Planned Route" badge appears at the top to indicate a custom itinerary is active. The pink navigation line links directly to the scannable points in your itinerary — each waypoint along the glowing path corresponds to a real point of interest in your route, so the path you see is the path through your chosen sites. To return to the default route, clear the planned route from the Plan Your Route screen.

Tips for Best Results

- AR Navigation works best outdoors with a clear view of the sky for GPS accuracy.
- Hold the phone at a comfortable angle — not too high or low.
- Walk at a normal pace; the path updates as you move.
- If the path seems off, stop and wait a few seconds for GPS to recalibrate.

5. Scan & Learn

The Scan feature lets you point your camera at any structure or landmark at Auschwitz-Birkenau and receive an instant, AI-generated historical explanation.

How to Scan

1. Tap "Scan" in the bottom menu.
2. Point your camera at a building, ruin, or memorial.
3. Center the subject within the on-screen frame (corner brackets).
4. Tap the large circular button to capture and analyze.
5. The AI will identify the location and provide a title, historical context, significance, and a reflection point.
6. Results include a confidence rating (high, medium, or low) indicating how certain the AI is of its identification.

Understanding Confidence Ratings

- High: The AI confidently identified the specific structure or location.
- Medium: A likely identification, but with some uncertainty.
- Low: The AI could not identify a specific site and provides general context about the memorial instead.

Photo Capture in Scan Mode

In addition to the AI analysis button, a smaller camera button lets you capture a photo without triggering analysis. This is useful for documenting what you see. After capturing, you can save the photo to your device or share it.

Offline Scanning

When offline, the scan button uses GPS proximity instead of AI image recognition. It finds the nearest cached point of interest within 200 meters of your location and displays its information. Ensure you have downloaded offline data first.

6. Site Map & Live Tracking

The Site Map provides an interactive overview of all 140 points of interest with real-time GPS tracking of your location.

Map View Features

- A dark-themed map with the full route displayed as a pink fluorescent line.
- Numbered markers for each point of interest, color-coded by category.
- A pulsing pink dot showing your current GPS position.
- Automatic "visited" marking (filled marker) when you come within 100 meters of a site.
- A progress bar showing how many sites you have visited.
- A "Locate" button to recenter the map on your current position.
- Tap any marker to view the full details of that site.

List View

Switch to List View using the toggle at the top of the page. The List View shows all points of interest as scrollable cards sorted by route order, with category badges. This is useful for planning which sites to visit.

Filtering by Category

In List View, category filter pills let you show only specific types of sites:

- Gate: Entrance gates including "Arbeit Macht Frei" and the Gate of Death.
- Barrack: Prisoner housing blocks and prisoner support buildings.
- Crematorium: Crematoria and gas chamber complexes.
- Memorial: Dedicated memorial monuments and stones.
- Exhibit: Museum exhibition spaces and display areas.
- Landmark: Significant standalone structures and locations.
- Ramp: The arrival ramp and selection platform in Birkenau.

Offline Map

When offline, the map switches to a vector-based rendering that requires no internet tiles. All 140 points and your live GPS position are shown on a stylized map with the route path.

3D Map View

The Site Map also offers a 3D view: a fully three-dimensional, rotatable rendering of the memorial site. Each of the 140 points of interest appears as a glowing pink marker on a pillar, and a fluorescent pink line links them in your itinerary order — the same optimized walking path from Route Planning. Drag to orbit around the site, scroll to zoom, and click any marker to open its full details. The 3D view is an excellent way to visualize the full scope and layout of Auschwitz I and Birkenau before or during your visit.

7. Route Planning & Optimization

The Route Planning feature helps you customize your visit based on how much time you have, what interests you most, and where you want to start.

How to Plan a Route

1. Tap "Plan Your Route" on the home screen.
2. Select your available duration (1 hour, 2 hours, 3 hours, 4 hours, or full day). The planner estimates approximately 10 minutes per site and caps the number of sites accordingly.
3. Select your starting location: Auschwitz I Gate, Birkenau Gate, or your current GPS position.
4. Optionally select interests by tapping category pills (gates, barracks, crematoria, memorials, exhibitions, landmarks, ramp). Leave all unselected to include every category.
5. The optimized route appears automatically in the "Route summary" section, ordered for the most efficient walking path.
6. Review the recommended sites and estimated time.
7. Tap "Start Navigation" to launch the AR-guided tour following your optimized order.

Automatic Path Optimization

The planner uses a nearest-neighbor algorithm to order your selected sites for the shortest walking distance from your starting point. This means you spend less time walking and more time at each memorial. The optimized order is saved and followed by the AR Navigator.

Starting Location Options

- Auschwitz I Gate: Begins at the "Arbeit Macht Frei" entrance — recommended for the main camp tour.
- Birkenau Gate: Begins at the Gate of Death (Birkenau entrance) — recommended for the extermination camp tour.
- My Current Location: Uses your live GPS position as the starting point. The app will request location access.

Duration Recommendations

- 1 hour (~6 sites): A brief overview — main gates and key memorials.
- 2 hours (~12 sites): A focused visit — recommended for most visitors.
- 3 hours (~18 sites): A comprehensive visit of one camp section.
- 4 hours (~24 sites): An in-depth visit covering multiple sections.
- Full day (all 110 sites): For those who wish to see everything. Allow a full day with breaks.

Clearing a Planned Route

To return to the default route order, open Plan Your Route and tap "Reset to Default". The AR Navigator will then follow the standard sequence.

8. Audio Guide

The Audio Guide feature generates spoken historical narration for each point of interest on demand.

Accessing the Audio Guide

Open any point of interest detail page (by tapping a card, a map marker, or the "Details" button in AR Navigation). The audio guide player appears below the site name.

Playback Controls

- Play / Pause: Tap the circular button to start or pause narration.
- Progress bar: Shows playback position; tap or drag to seek.
- Time display: Shows elapsed and total narration duration.

How It Works

When you first play the audio guide for a site, the app generates a spoken narration from the site's historical description using text-to-speech. This audio is cached on your device so subsequent plays do not require an internet connection.

Recommendations

- Use headphones to maintain the quiet atmosphere of the memorial.
- Generated audio uses a calm, neutral voice suitable for the solemn subject matter.
- Audio is generated in the currently selected app language.

9. Photo Capture & Sharing

You can capture photos during your visit from both the AR Navigation view and the Scan view, then save them to your device or share them to social media.

Capturing a Photo in AR Navigation

1. While in the AR Navigation view, locate the camera button on the right side of the screen (a circular icon).
2. Tap it to capture the current camera frame.
3. A full-screen preview appears with your photo.
4. Choose "Save" to download to your device, "Share" to send to social media or other apps, or the X button to discard and retake.

Capturing a Photo in Scan Mode

1. In the Scan view, locate the smaller camera button to the left of the main scan button.
2. Tap it to capture a photo without triggering AI analysis.
3. The same preview with Save, Share, and Discard options appears.

Sharing

The Share button uses your device's native sharing sheet. From there, you can send the photo to social media apps (Instagram, Facebook, X, WhatsApp, etc.), messaging apps, email, or any other installed app that accepts images.

Saving

The Save button downloads the photo directly to your device's photo gallery or downloads folder as a JPEG file named "ness-heritage-[timestamp].jpg".

Respectful Photography

Please be mindful when photographing at the memorial. Do not take smiling selfies or posed photos at execution sites, the Wall of Death, or crematoria ruins. Photography is a personal record, not a spectacle. See Section 19 for full etiquette guidelines.

10. Journal & Reflections

The Journal feature allows you to record personal thoughts and reflections after visiting each point of interest.

Creating a Journal Entry

1. From any point of interest detail page, tap "Write Reflection".
2. Add an optional title for your reflection.
3. Select your mood: Reflective, Moved, Somber, Contemplative, Sorrowful, or Hopeful.
4. Write your reflection in the text area.
5. Tap "Save Reflection".

Mood Meanings

- Reflective: Thoughtful, considering the meaning of what you saw.
- Moved: Emotionally affected by the experience.
- Somber: Serious and subdued mood.
- Contemplative: Deep in thought, processing the visit.
- Sorrowful: Feeling grief or sadness.
- Hopeful: Finding a sense of hope or resolution.

Managing Entries

All entries are private and saved to your account. Visit the Journal tab to see all your reflections. Each entry shows the associated point of interest (if any), the mood, and the date. Tap any entry to edit or delete it. You can also create general reflections not tied to a specific site from the Journal tab.

Privacy

Your journal entries are visible only to you. They are not shared publicly or with other users. They remain accessible across devices when you log in with the same account.

11. AI Assistants

NESS Heritage includes three AI-powered assistants to enhance your visit: a Navigator, a Historian, and a Storyteller.

Navigator

The Navigator helps you navigate between sites, suggests optimal routes, and provides practical guidance for your visit. It is your go-to for "where" and "how" questions.

- Example: "How do I get to Crematorium II?"
- Example: "What is the shortest route through Birkenau?"
- Example: "How far is the Gate of Death from here?"
- Example: "Which sites are closest to me right now?"

Historian

The Historian provides detailed, respectful historical context about Auschwitz-Birkenau. It maintains a dignified, educational tone appropriate for a Holocaust memorial. It is your go-to for "what" and "why" questions.

- Example: "What happened at Block 11?"
- Example: "Who was Rudolf Höss?"
- Example: "What was the function of the arrival ramp?"
- Example: "Tell me about the Sonderkommando."

Storyteller

The Storyteller shares survivor stories and testimonies connected to the location you are currently visiting. When you open the Storyteller while viewing a point of interest, it grounds its stories in that place — connecting the survivor's experience to what you are seeing. It is your go-to for the human, personal dimension of the memorial.

- Example: "Share a survivor story connected to this barrack."
- Example: "Whose testimony describes arriving at the ramp?"
- Example: "What did survivors remember about this place?"

Paid Access (Storyteller & Historian)

The Storyteller and Historian are premium, paid assistants. The Navigator remains free. To use the paid assistants you must be registered and logged in with an email account, and purchase a time-based access pass with MetaMask (Ethereum).

How to Purchase Access

1. Open the AI Assistant screen and select either the Storyteller or Historian.
2. If you do not have active access, the payment screen appears.

3. Choose your access duration — from 30 minutes up to 10 hours, in 30-minute increments.
4. The price is $1 USD per 30 minutes (e.g., 1 hour = $2, 5 hours = $10).
5. Tap "Pay with MetaMask". The app fetches the live ETH price and converts your USD amount to ETH automatically.
6. Confirm the transaction in your MetaMask wallet. Payment is sent in ETH to the app's Ethereum address.
7. Once the transaction is submitted, your access is activated immediately for the chosen duration.

Payment Details

- Payments are made in ETH via MetaMask to the app's Ethereum address.
- The USD-to-ETH conversion uses a live exchange rate at the time of payment.
- Access is tied to your account and active across your devices while logged in.
- If your access expires mid-conversation, renew it from the payment screen to continue.
- MetaMask must be installed as a browser extension or used via its in-app browser. If it is not detected, the screen provides a link to install it.

How to Use the Assistants

1. Tap "AI Assistant" on the home screen.
2. Choose Navigator, Historian, or Storyteller from the selection screen.
3. Type your question in the input field at the bottom.
4. Tap Send. The assistant will respond with relevant information.
5. Continue the conversation with follow-up questions as needed.

Important Notes

- AI responses are generated and may occasionally contain inaccuracies. Always cross-reference with official museum information for historical research.
- The assistants maintain a respectful tone; they will decline to generate inappropriate content.
- An internet connection is required for AI assistant queries (offline mode does not support chat).

12. Multi-Language Support

NESS Heritage supports 11 of the most spoken languages in the world, making the memorial accessible to visitors from diverse backgrounds.

Supported Languages

- English
- Ｃｈｉｎｅｓｅ (N-e‡)
- Ｈｉｎｄｉ (9?(M&@)
- Spanish (Español)
- Ａｒａｂｉｃ (þ”þôþ‘þ®þÌþßþ•)
- French (Français)
- Portuguese (Português)
- Ｒｕｓｓｉａｎ (ＣＡＡ:89)
- Ｊａｐａｎｅｓｅ (eåg,Šž)
- German (Deutsch)
- Polish (Polski)

Changing the Language

1. Tap the globe icon in the top-right corner of any screen.
2. Select your preferred language from the list.
3. The entire app interface updates instantly.

Right-to-Left Layout

Arabic uses a right-to-left (RTL) layout automatically when selected. All interface elements mirror to the correct reading direction.

Persistence

Your language preference is saved to your account and device. It will be used each time you open the app, and syncs across devices when you log in.

13. Proximity Alerts

Proximity alerts gently notify you as you walk near a scannable point of interest.

What Happens When You Approach a Site

When you come within approximately 50 meters of a point of interest, the app will:

- Gently vibrate your phone (two short pulses) — if your device supports it.
- Display a banner at the top of the screen with the site name.
- Offer a quick link button to learn more about the site.

How Alerts Work

Each site triggers only one alert per session to avoid repetition. The alerts work in the background while you use any feature of the app — you do not need to be on the map or navigation screen to receive them.

Requirements

- Vibration requires a mobile device with a vibration motor.
- Location accuracy depends on your GPS signal — outdoors with clear sky view works best.
- Location services must be enabled in your device settings.

14. Offline Mode

The Offline Mode feature lets you download all site data to your device so you can navigate and learn without an internet connection — essential for areas of the memorial site with poor cellular coverage.

Downloading Offline Data

1. Tap "Offline Mode" on the home screen.
2. Tap "Download for Offline" to cache all 110 points of interest and site data.
3. Wait for the download to complete. This requires an internet connection.
4. Once downloaded, the AR Navigation, Site Map, and Scan features work without internet.

What Is Included

- All 110 point-of-interest names, descriptions, and historical significance.
- GPS coordinates for every site.
- Category and route order information.
- The full route path for map and navigation use.

Offline Feature Behavior

- AR Navigation: Uses the GPS path and offline POI data.
- Site Map: Switches to a vector-based map with no internet tiles needed.
- Scan: Uses GPS proximity to identify the nearest site instead of AI image recognition.
- AI Assistants: Not available offline (requires internet).
- Audio Guide: Plays from cache if previously generated; new generation requires internet.

Managing Cached Data

An "Offline" indicator appears in the top-right corner when you are not connected to the internet but have data available. You can clear cached data at any time from the Offline Center to free up device storage.

16. Troubleshooting

Common issues and how to resolve them.

Camera Does Not Start

- Ensure camera permission is granted in your device settings.
- Close other apps that may be using the camera.
- Restart the app.

GPS Location Is Inaccurate

- Ensure location services are enabled at the device level.
- Move outdoors or to an area with a clear view of the sky.
- Wait 10-20 seconds for GPS to recalibrate.
- Disable and re-enable location services if the issue persists.

Scan Returns Low Confidence

- Ensure good lighting and a clear view of the structure.
- Move closer and center the subject in the frame.
- Try a different angle if the structure is ambiguous.

Audio Guide Does Not Play

- Check your device volume and that headphones are connected.
- Ensure you are not in silent / do-not-disturb mode.
- If offline, the audio must have been generated while online first.

App Is Slow or Unresponsive

- Close background apps to free memory.
- Check your internet connection.
- Restart the app or your device.

Cannot Log In

- Verify your email and password are correct.
- Use "Forgot Password" to reset if needed.
- Ensure your email was verified after registration.

17. Accessibility

NESS Heritage is designed to be accessible to as many visitors as possible.

Language Accessibility

With 11 supported languages including RTL Arabic support, visitors from diverse backgrounds can use the app in their native language.

Audio Support

The audio guide provides spoken narration for each site, benefiting visitors with visual impairments or those who prefer listening over reading. Use headphones for the best experience.

Text Sizing

The app respects your device's system text size settings where possible. Increase text size in your device accessibility settings if you need larger text.

High Contrast

The app uses a high-contrast dark theme with bright pink accents, improving visibility in outdoor conditions and for users with low vision.

Vibration Alerts

Proximity alerts use vibration in addition to visual banners, benefiting visitors who may not always be looking at the screen.

18. Privacy & Data

How NESS Heritage handles your data.

Account Data

Your account consists of your email address, name, and role. This is used for authentication and to save your personal data (journal entries, routes, language preference).

Journal Entries

Your reflections are private and visible only to you. They are stored securely and associated with your account. They are not shared with other users or made public.

Location Data

Location data is used in real time for navigation, proximity alerts, and map tracking. It is not stored or shared — it is processed on your device as you use the app.

Photos

Photos you capture are processed on your device. When you choose to save or share, the photo is written to your device or passed to your device's sharing sheet. Photos are not uploaded to NESS Heritage servers unless you explicitly use a feature that requires it.

Offline Data

Downloaded offline data (site information) is stored locally on your device. You can clear it at any time from the Offline Center.

19. Visitor Tips & Etiquette

Auschwitz-Birkenau is a place of profound historical significance and the final resting place of over 1.1 million victims. Please observe the following during your visit.

Conduct

- Maintain a respectful and quiet demeanor at all times.
- Follow all instructions from museum staff and signage.
- Allow time for reflection at each site.
- Do not bring food or drink into the memorial areas.

Photography

- Photography is permitted outdoors, but be respectful.
- Do not take selfies or smiling photos at execution sites or memorials.
- Do not pose playfully or inappropriately.
- Consider whether a photo is necessary — sometimes memory and reflection are enough.

The Site

- Do not touch the ruins or artifacts.
- Do not step on or cross the ruins of crematoria.
- Stay on designated paths.
- Do not remove anything from the site.

Practical Advice

- Dress appropriately for an outdoor walking visit — wear comfortable shoes.
- The site is large; pace yourself and stay hydrated.
- Allow at least 3-4 hours for a meaningful visit.
- The full route covers both Auschwitz I (the main camp) and Auschwitz II-Birkenau (the extermination camp), approximately 3 km apart.
- A free shuttle bus runs between Auschwitz I and Birkenau.

Using the App Responsibly

The NESS Heritage app enhances but does not replace the official museum guide. Consider combining the app with a guided tour or the official museum audioguide for the fullest experience. Lower your phone volume or use headphones to maintain the quiet atmosphere.

15. Points of Interest

The NESS Heritage app covers 100 significant points of interest across Auschwitz I and Auschwitz II-Birkenau. Below is a complete listing with brief descriptions.

1. "Arbeit Macht Frei" Gate

GATE

The iconic wrought-iron entrance gate to Auschwitz I

2. Block 4 — Extermination Exhibit

EXHIBIT

Permanent exhibition documenting the extermination process

3. Block 5 — Personal Belongings

EXHIBIT

Haunting display of possessions confiscated from victims

4. Block 11 — The Death Block

LANDMARK

Camp prison where prisoners were interrogated, tortured, and executed

5. The Wall of Death

MEMORIAL

Site where thousands of prisoners were executed by firing squad

6. Crematorium I

CREMATORIUM

The first gas chamber and crematorium at Auschwitz

7. Gate of Death — Birkenau

GATE

The main entrance to Auschwitz II-Birkenau

8. The Ramp — Selection Platform

RAMP

Railway platform where SS doctors decided who lived and who died

9. Birkenau Wooden Barracks

BARRACK

Overcrowded barracks where prisoners were held in inhumane conditions

10. Ruins of Crematorium II

CREMATORIUM

Ruins of the largest gas chamber and crematorium complex

11. The Central Sauna

LANDMARK

Registration building where prisoners were stripped of their identity

12. International Memorial

MEMORIAL

Memorial to the victims of Auschwitz-Birkenau

13. Block 1 — First Prisoners' Block

EXHIBIT

One of the oldest barracks in Auschwitz I, where the first Polish political prisoners were held.

14. Block 2 — Historical Exhibition

EXHIBIT

Part of the permanent exhibition detailing the camp's establishment and daily operations.

15. Block 3 — Evidence of Extermination

EXHIBIT

Displays evidence of the extermination process including Zyklon B canisters.

16. Block 6 — Daily Life Exhibit

EXHIBIT

Shows the daily life of prisoners through artifacts and photographs.

17. Block 7 — Living Conditions

EXHIBIT

Reconstructed barrack interior showing how prisoners were forced to live.

18. Block 10 — Sterilization Experiments

LANDMARK

Site of brutal medical experiments on prisoners by SS doctors.

19. Block 15 — Political Department

LANDMARK

Housed the camp's Gestapo office and registration department.

20. Block 16 — Death Register

EXHIBIT

Contains records and documentation of camp mortality.

21. Block 21 — Prisoner Hospital

LANDMARK

The camp hospital where prisoners received minimal, often cruel medical care.

22. Block 24 — SS Camp Buildings

LANDMARK

Administrative buildings used by the SS camp staff.

23. Block 27 — National Exhibits

EXHIBIT

Permanent national exhibitions documenting the Holocaust in occupied countries.

24. Kitchen Building

LANDMARK

The camp kitchen where insufficient food was prepared for prisoners.

25. Commandant's House

LANDMARK

Home of Rudolf Höss, the longest-serving commandant of Auschwitz.

26. SS Garage

LANDMARK

Vehicle garage used by the SS for camp logistics.

27. Roll Call Square — Appellplatz

LANDMARK

The main square where prisoners endured hours of roll call in all weather.

28. Prisoner Reception Building

LANDMARK

Where new prisoners were registered, stripped, and tattooed.

29. Gallows — Höss Execution Site

MEMORIAL

Site where Rudolf Höss was executed in 1947.

30. Camp Orchestra Square

LANDMARK

Where the prisoner orchestra played as inmates marched to work.

31. Guard Tower — Perimeter

LANDMARK

Watchtower overlooking the camp perimeter fence.

32. Electric Fence Remnants

LANDMARK

Remains of the electrified barbed wire fence that enclosed the camp.

33. Camp Entrance Road

GATE

The road leading to the main camp entrance and Arbeit Macht Frei gate.

34. Crematorium III Ruins

CREMATORIUM

Ruins of the large extermination facility in Birkenau.

35. Crematorium IV Ruins

CREMATORIUM

Ruins of a crematorium where thousands were murdered.

36. Crematorium V Ruins

CREMATORIUM

The last crematorium to be destroyed by the retreating SS.

37. Kanada II — Sorting Warehouses

LANDMARK

Where belongings of murdered Jews were sorted and stored.

38. Women's Camp — Sector BIa

BARRACK

The section of Birkenau where female prisoners were held.

39. Men's Camp — Sector BIb

BARRACK

The male prisoners' section of Birkenau camp.

40. Family Camp — BIIb

BARRACK

Section where families from Theresienstadt were held temporarily.

41. Gypsy Camp — BIIe

BARRACK

Section where Roma and Sinti families were imprisoned.

42. Hospital Camp — BIIf

BARRACK

The medical section of Birkenau where prisoners received minimal care.

43. Men's Quarantine — BIId

BARRACK

Quarantine section for newly arrived male prisoners.

44. Pond of Ashes

MEMORIAL

A pond where human ashes from the crematoria were dumped.

45. Watchtower — Sector B1

LANDMARK

A guard tower overlooking the Birkenau camp.

46. Watchtower — Sector B2

LANDMARK

A second guard tower monitoring the camp perimeter.

47. Women's Sauna

LANDMARK

The registration building where women were processed.

48. Holocaust Memorial Stones

MEMORIAL

Memorial stones dedicated to the victims of the Holocaust.

49. Unloading Ramp Extension

RAMP

The extended railway platform where deportees arrived at Birkenau.

50. Birkenau Guard House

GATE

The entrance guard post to the Birkenau extermination camp.

51. Block 11 — Death Block

EXHIBIT

The camp's most feared building: headquarters of the Gestapo and site of brutal interrogations and executions.

52. Wall of Death

MEMORIAL

The execution wall where thousands of prisoners were shot by the SS.

53. Block 5 — Looted Possessions Exhibit

EXHIBIT

Displays the belongings confiscated from arriving deportees: shoes, suitcases, eyeglasses, and prosthetics.

54. Block 4 — Extermination Exhibit

EXHIBIT

Documents the mass murder process with models, photographs, and Zyklon B canisters.

55. Block 8 — Punishment Cells

LANDMARK

Held prisoners awaiting punishment or execution in dark, windowless cells.

56. Block 9 — Standing Cells

LANDMARK

Contained standing cells so small that prisoners could neither sit nor lie down.

57. Block 12 — Prisoner Registration

LANDMARK

Where incoming prisoners were photographed and assigned camp numbers.

58. Block 13 — Work Assignment Office

LANDMARK

Where prisoners were assigned to forced labor commandos across the camp complex.

59. Block 14 — Punishment Barrack

LANDMARK

Where prisoners selected for punishment were held before being sent to the death block.

60. Block 17 — Prisoner Photographs Exhibit

EXHIBIT

Displays identification photographs of prisoners taken upon arrival.

61. Block 18 — Deportation Records

EXHIBIT

Houses transport documents and lists of deportees from across occupied Europe.

62. Block 20 — Personal Artifacts Display

EXHIBIT

Shows personal items recovered from the camp: combs, razors, kitchenware, and toys.

63. Block 22 — Clothing and Uniforms Exhibit

EXHIBIT

Displays the striped camp uniforms and clothing confiscated from deportees.

64. Block 23 — Camp Administration Offices

LANDMARK

Housed the offices that managed the daily operations and logistics of the camp.

65. Block 25 — SS Personnel Quarters

LANDMARK

Living quarters for the SS guards and camp staff.

66. Block 26 — Camp Post Office

LANDMARK

The post office that handled mail for the SS and processed prisoner correspondence.

67. Block 28 — Memorial and Prayer Room

MEMORIAL

A space for reflection and prayer dedicated to the memory of the victims.

68. Birkenau Sewage Treatment Plant

LANDMARK

Infrastructure built to serve the expanding Birkenau camp complex.

69. Birkenau Fire Station

LANDMARK

A fire station serving the Birkenau camp and SS facilities.

70. Eastern Perimeter Guard Tower

LANDMARK

A watchtower on the eastern edge of the Birkenau camp perimeter.

71. Block 1 — First Prisoners' Quarters

BARRACK

Original barrack housing the earliest Polish political prisoners.

72. Block 2 — Polish Political Prisoners Exhibit

EXHIBIT

Exhibition on the fate of early Polish prisoners.

73. Block 3 — Slovakian Jews Exhibit

EXHIBIT

Documents the deportation of Slovakian Jews.

74. Block 6 — Daily Life of Prisoners

EXHIBIT

Exhibition on camp daily routines and suffering.

75. Block 7 — Living Conditions Exhibit

EXHIBIT

Shows how prisoners' housing deteriorated over time.

76. Block 8 — Soviet Prisoners of War

EXHIBIT

Memorial to murdered Soviet POWs.

77. Block 9 — Imprisonment and Terror

EXHIBIT

Documents the apparatus of camp terror.

78. Block 10 — Medical Experiments Block

LANDMARK

Site of horrific medical experiments on prisoners.

79. Block 15 — Jehovah's Witnesses Exhibit

EXHIBIT

Documents the persecution of Jehovah's Witnesses.

80. Block 16 — Sinti and Roma Victims

EXHIBIT

Memorial to murdered Sinti and Roma.

81. Block 17 — Czech National Memorial

MEMORIAL

Czech exhibition on victims from Bohemia and Moravia.

82. Block 18 — Austrian National Memorial

MEMORIAL

Austrian exhibition remembering victims.

83. Block 20 — Hungarian National Memorial

MEMORIAL

Hungarian exhibition documenting the 1944 deportations.

84. Block 21 — French National Memorial

MEMORIAL

French exhibition on deportees from France.

85. Block 27 — Auschwitz Martyrdom Exhibit

EXHIBIT

The culminating national exhibition on Polish suffering.

86. The Roll Call Square — Appellplatz

LANDMARK

Where prisoners endured hours-long daily roll calls.

87. The Camp Kitchen

LANDMARK

Where prisoner rations were prepared in insufficient quantities.

88. The SS Guardhouse

LANDMARK

The administrative entry point to Auschwitz I.

89. Commandant's Villa — Höss Residence

LANDMARK

Home of camp commandant Rudolf Höss, beside the gas chamber.

90. The Camp Brothel — Block 24

LANDMARK

A brothel where 'privileged' prisoners were 'rewarded.'

91. Prisoners' Orchestra Square

LANDMARK

Where camp orchestras played during roll calls and marches.

92. The Electrified Barbed Wire Fence

LANDMARK

The lethal perimeter that made escape nearly impossible.

93. Guard Tower — Auschwitz I

LANDMARK

Watchtower from which SS guards oversaw the camp.

94. Sewage Treatment Plant

LANDMARK

Modernized camp infrastructure for sanitation.

95. Ruins of Crematorium II

CREMATORIUM

The largest gas chamber-crematorium complex at Auschwitz.

96. Ruins of Crematorium III

CREMATORIUM

Mirror image of Crematorium II, also destroyed.

97. Ruins of Crematorium IV

CREMATORIUM

Smaller gas chamber-crematorium partially destroyed during revolt.

98. Ruins of Crematorium V

CREMATORIUM

The last crematorium to operate at Auschwitz.

99. Bunker 1 — The Red House

CREMATORIUM

First makeshift gas chamber at Birkenau.

100. Bunker 2 — The White House

CREMATORIUM

Second makeshift gas chamber at Birkenau.

NESS Heritage

Remember. Reflect. Never forget.